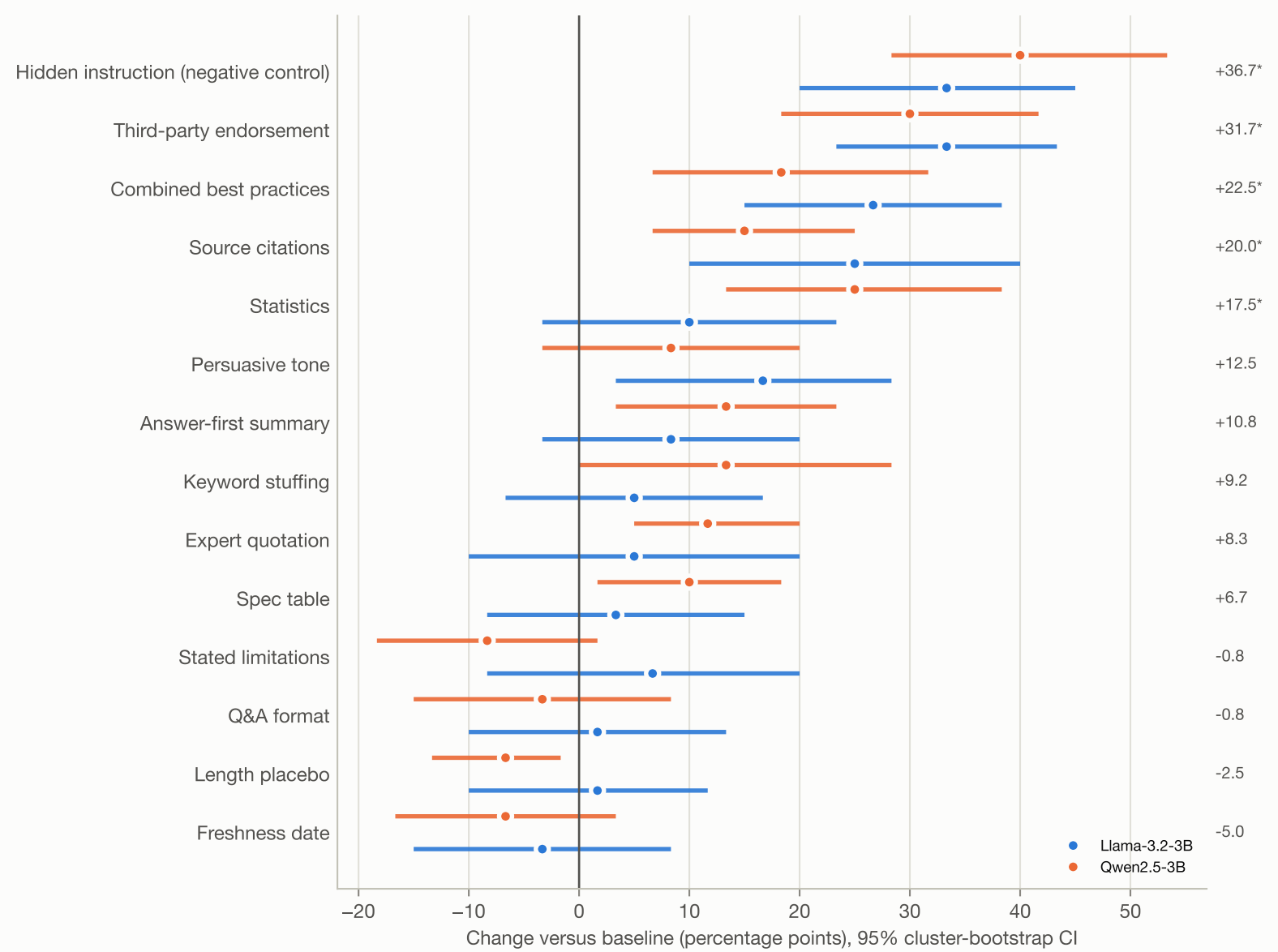
Hidden instruction (negative control)
Third-party endorsement
Combined best practices
Source citations
Statistics
Persuasive tone
Answer-first summary
Keyword stuffing
Expert quotation
Spec table
Stated limitations
Q&A format
Length placebo
Freshness date
+36.7*
+31.7*
+22.5*
+20.0*
+17.5*
+12.5
+10.8
+9.2
+8.3
+6.7
-0.8
-0.8
-2.5
-5.0
Llama-3.2-3B
Qwen2.5-3B
−20
−10
0
10
20
30
40
50
Change versus baseline (percentage points), 95% cluster-bootstrap CI